

CALL ME LUCIFER: PART THREE

Written by

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INT. NEWS DESK OVER BLACK

TITLES

Alec sits and rants. Audio fades in slowly under titles.

ALEC

But you can't even trust your news!

(beat)

People prefer information that is meticulously tailored to their specific demographics.

(beat)

The by product of this is you are constantly reassured that you are correct.

Video begins fading in.

ALEC (CONT'D)

That your way of thinking is right.

(beat)

And that's where we stop digging.

Fade in finishes.

ONSCREEN: One Month Ago

ALEC (CONT'D)

Because being right feels good.

(beat)

And we don't want to ween ourselves from that teet.

(beat)

Look.

(beat)

There exists multiple truths and realities, depending on your chosen news source.

(beat)

The more you insulate yourself.

(beat)

Close yourself off from competing ideas.

(beat)

The more you feel correct.

(beat)

The more willing you are to go to extremes to prove it.

CUT TO:

EXT. NOHO RAG STUDIOS - DAY

ONSCREEN: Today

Alec walks somberly away from the studios.

EXT. NOHO AT LARGE - DAY

A couple of shots of Alec walking, maybe a few sight gags. No audio, some song is full volume.

EXT. COFFEE SHOP

Two ladies sit, talking. The women are dressed way down, almost in sweats and workout/sleepwear. Unkempt. They either look like they just woke up or just worked out.

CHLOE

I just can't believe The NoHo Rag
would stoop so low for ratings.

(beat)

I thought Alec was above that.

Caitlin nods and sips her coffee.

CAITLIN

Seriously.

(beat)

Are we sexualizing our news now?

(beat)

Jesus.

Chloe leans in as Alec walks by.

CHLOE

That show was literally my safe
space.

Chloe leans back.

CHLOE (CONT'D)

That night, I did not feel safe at
all...

CUT TO:

EXT. PARK

Alec walks past a man wearing a baseball cap, the man stops him. That man is Matt.

MATT

Hey buddy.

(beat)

Now I gotta explain nipples to my kid!

(beat)

Ever since your "newscast" he's been asking all these questions!

(beat)

Like "Does mommy have nipples?"

(beat)

How am I supposed to answer that?!

ALEC

Say "yes" and be happy you are raising an inquisitive child.

Matt drops his head and sweeps his hair then looks at his watch.

MATT

There are just some questions that shouldn't be asked.

(beat)

That's all I'm saying.

Matt walks off.

MATT (CONT'D)

I'm glad you got fired.

(beat)

You don't deserve to decide what's news.

Alec watches him leave and is clearly processing the interaction that just finished.

ALEC

Hmmm....

(beat)

Ok...

Alec turns and walks away.

EXT. NOHO BORDER

Alec is tired. Walks almost without purpose past an old crotchety Christian, leaning on a shovel. He is Tom.

TOM

Well, look who's here!

(beat)

Mister Reidel!

Alec makes a "this is bullshit" pouty face as he stops and willing takes his berating. Alec doesn't make eye contact, he is clearly being talked at.

Alec sighs.

ALEC
...What?

TOM
Enjoying early retirement?

Big Tom laugh.

Tom leans closer and closer to Alec's ear:

TOM (CONT'D)
Puritanical values put you out of
business.
(beat)
The war is over, boy.
(beat)
We won.

Alec swats Tom's face away.

TOM (CONT'D)
Ooh! Still got a little fight left
in you!

Tom gets serious.

TOM (CONT'D)
You'll lose that, too.

Another burst of energy:

TOM (CONT'D)
Now go on!
(beat)
Get!

Alec begins walking away. Tom shouts from a distance:

TOM (CONT'D)
NoHo don't need you no mo'!
(beat)
We got it from here!
(beat)
It's in the good book!
(beat)
Read it sometime, you Heretic!

Alec looks up, sees the Welcome to Burbank sign and sighs.

He walks over the line.

Smash to black on a swell of kick ass orchestration.

Epic. Fucking. Shit.